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OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY, OSOGBO

NSG 501 — Past Questions & Materials

by Renance

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Paper 1 of 7 — NSG 501 - FAMILY AND COMMUNITY VIOLENCE

GROUP 3

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

DEPARTMENT OF NURSING SCIENCE,
COLLEGE OF HEALTH SCIENCES, OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY
COMMUNITY HEALTH NURSING
NSG 501

UNIT VI; FAMILY AND COMMUNITY VIOLENCE
GROUP 3

TOPIC; CAUSES AND PREVENTION OF VIOLENCE

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INTRODUCTION

- Violence is a relatively common type of human behaviour that occurs throughout the world.

People of any age

may be violent, although older adolescents and young adults are most likely to engage in violent behaviour.

Violence has a number of negative effects on those who witness or experience it, and children are especially

susceptible to its harm. Fortunately, various programs have been successful at preventing and reducing

violence.

CAUSES OF VIOLENCE

Violence within families and communities remains a significant societal concern, impacting individuals' physical,

emotional, and social well-being. Understanding the causes and implementing preventive measures are critical to

addressing this issue.

- THE CAUSES INCLUDES

1.INDIVIDUAL FACTORS:

Mental Health Disorders: Conditions like depression, anxiety, and personality disorders may lead to aggression

and violent outbursts.

Substance Abuse: Excessive alcohol consumption and drug use often impair judgment and increase violent tendencies.

History of Trauma: Individuals who have experienced abuse, neglect, or exposure to violence in childhood are more likely to exhibit violent behavior later in life.

2.FAMILY-RELATED CAUSES:

Dysfunctional Family Dynamics: Poor communication, unresolved conflicts, and emotional neglect can contribute to a toxic family environment.

Intergenerational Violence: Witnessing or experiencing violence within the family often perpetuates a cycle of violence across generations.

Economic Hardship: Financial stress, poverty, and unemployment increase tension and conflict within families, often escalating to violence.

3.COMMUNITY-RELATED CAUSES:

Social Inequality: Marginalization, lack of access to basic services, and economic disparities foster resentment and conflict in communities.

Prevalence of Crime: High crime rates, gang activities, and weak law enforcement exacerbate community violence.

Cultural Norms: Acceptance or glorification of violence in certain cultures or traditions normalizes aggressive behavior.

4.SOCIETAL FACTORS:

Gender Inequality: Patriarchal systems and societal norms that devalue women's rights often result in domestic and gender-based violence.

Media Influence: Frequent exposure to violent movies, video games, and social media content can desensitize individuals and promote aggressive behaviors.

Inadequate Legal Systems: Weak judicial frameworks and lack of enforcement allow violence to persist with impunity.

PREVENTION OF VIOLENCE

1. EDUCATION AND AWARENESS: Implement educational programs to teach children and adults about non-violent conflict resolution, communication, and empathy.

Conduct campaigns in schools and communities to raise awareness about the impact of violence and how to prevent it.

2. PROMOTING GENDER EQUALITY: Empower women and girls through education and economic opportunities to reduce the

likelihood of gender-based violence.

Encourage shared responsibility in households and communities, reducing power imbalances.

3. BUILDING STRONGER COMMUNITIES: Strengthen community ties and encourage collective problem-solving.

Support neighbourhood groups, local initiatives, and grassroots organizations that work towards peaceful resolutions.

4. ACCESS TO MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES: Ensure that communities have access to mental health resources, including

counselling and therapy services, to help individuals cope with stress and trauma, which can otherwise contribute to violent behaviour.

Offer crisis intervention and counselling services for those at risk of perpetrating or being victims of violence.

5. SUPPORT FOR AT-RISK YOUTH: Provide mentorship programs, after-school activities, and safe spaces to steer at-risk youth

away from violence. Engage them in skills-building programs that offer educational and employment opportunities.

6. ECONOMIC AND EMPLOYMENT SUPPORT: Focus on economic empowerment, including job training, fair wages, and job

security, as poverty and lack of opportunity can contribute to violent behaviour. Provide financial support programs that reduce

inequality and stress.

7. STRONG LEGAL FRAMEWORKS AND ENFORCEMENT: Strengthen laws that protect individuals from violence (e.g.,

domestic violence and child abuse) and ensure swift and fair enforcement of these laws. Provide legal aid for victims to ensure they

have access to justice.

8. EARLY INTERVENTION AND FAMILY SUPPORT: Early identification of families at risk of violence and providing

necessary interventions such as family therapy and parenting support programs.

Train health professionals to recognize signs of domestic violence or abuse and intervene early.

9. MEDIA AND SOCIAL MEDIA CAMPAIGNS: Use media platforms to promote positive behaviour, conflict resolution, and

social justice.

Engage celebrities and influencers to speak out against violence and encourage peace.

10. POLICY ADVOCACY AND REFORM: Advocate for stronger, clearer policies that address violence, including better support

for victims, stricter laws, and improved law enforcement training.

Involve policymakers in creating comprehensive violence prevention programs that involve public health, education, and criminal

justice sectors.

11. CULTURAL AND RELIGIOUS LEADERS ENGAGEMENT: Involve community leaders such as religious figures, cultural

representatives, and local influencers in promoting non-violent behaviour.

Encourage discussions and dialogue around cultural beliefs and practices that could perpetuate violence and provide alternatives.

12. DEVELOPING SAFE SPACES FOR VULNERABLE GROUPS: Create shelters and safe spaces for individuals at risk of

violence, such as victims of domestic violence, refugees, or marginalized groups.

Promote community centers as safe spaces where people can seek help and support.

13. RESTORATIVE JUSTICE PROGRAMS:

Implement restorative justice programs that focus on healing rather than punishment, offering victims the opportunity to meet with

offenders in a controlled, mediated environment.

Paper 2 of 7 — NSG 501 Community Midwifery Unit II

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

NSG 501

COMMUNITY MIDWIFERY

LECTURER

MRS ADENIYI V. A.

Unit II: THE COMMUNITY

- Advocacy- Definition, steps and skill
- Family pattern, political, cultural, social and economic structures.
- Health patterns, factors influencing health and diseases.
- Modes of health promotion, accidents and disease prevention in the community.
- The role of health education, environmental sanitation and maintenance of environmental health.
- Health surveillance, motivation and community participation in the control of communicable diseases

Advocacy- Definition, steps and skill

- Advocacy is defined as a set of actions undertaken by a group of individuals or an organizations working in partnership to build consensus, gain support or create a favorable environment for introducing or changing specific strategies, program, laws or policies. In health care delivery system, it can simply mean defending the right of patients/clients. The Advocacy in community midwifery is a dynamic process and every health worker must be involved.

Steps in Advocacy Process

- Proper understanding of the subject matter
- Identify and clarify issue
- Build partnership
- Select audiences
- Develop messages centered on goals
- Determine communication channel
- Prepare carefully for meetings and encounters
- Monitor and evaluate

Skills involved in Midwifery Advocacy

- Communication skills
- Critical thinking skills
- Cultural competence skills
- Conflict resolution skills
- Leadership skills

- Self-care skills
- Professional boundaries and responsibilities skills

Family pattern, political, cultural, social and economic structures.

- Family is a group of people related either by consanguinity (by recognized birth) or affinity (by marriage or other relationship). It forms the basis for social order.. The purpose of the family is to maintain the well-being of its members and of society. Ideally, families offer predictability, structure, and safety as members mature and learn to participate in the community. Historically, most human societies use family as the primary purpose of attachment, nurturance, and socialization (Wikipedia)

Family pattern/Structure

- Family structures is the basic grouping of members in a family. It comes in various shapes and sizes, but each one is just as valid as the next. Understanding family structure can better help to figure out the dynamics of relatives and how to make relationships developmentally appropriate.

- In life, family composition has affected children's lives in important ways. The size and structure of the family and its capacity to sustain itself has played a critical role in how children are raised, their level of formal education, and whether or not they participate in the labor force.

Common Family Types

- Family types have changed over the years in accordance with shifts in modern cultures' acceptance of structural changes. There are six types of family structures that are considered common. It is important to note that this article stresses the idea that one type of family structure is not placed above another. These structures include:

- Nuclear families
- Single-parent families
- Extended families
- Childless families
- Stepfamilies
- Grandparent families

Types of family: Nuclear family

- Nuclear families, also known as elementary or traditional families, consist of two parents (usually married or common law)

and their children. Nuclear families typically have one or more children; they may be biological or adopted, but the main

idea is that the parents are raising their kids together in the family home.

Strengths of nuclear families

- Financially stable, both parents usually work now
- Children raised in a stable parenting situation
- Consistency
- Emphasis on health and education
- Focus on communication

Weaknesses of nuclear families

- Exclusion of extended family can lead to isolation and stress
- Can struggle with conflict resolution
- Nuclear families can become too child-focused, resulting in self-centered children and families neglecting other important

things

Types of family: Single family

- Single-parent families consist of one parent with one or more kids. In these cases, the parent either never

married, widowed, or divorced. This has been on the rise since the 1960s when divorce rates started going up

(and so did births happening out of wedlock). And these could be due to many different factors, from leaving

behind outdated gender roles to feeling comfortable being independent and achieving the goal of raising a child,

regardless of the presence of a spouse or not.

Strengths of single-parent families

- Family can become very close
- Learn to household duties
- Children and parents can become very resilient

Weaknesses of single-parent families

- Families may have difficulty getting by on one income
- It can be difficult for single parents to work full-time and still afford quality childcare

Types of family: Extended family

- This is family with two or more adults who are related through blood or marriage, usually along with children. This often includes aunts, uncles, cousins, or other relatives living under the same roof. Typically, extended families live together for social support and to achieve common goals.

Strengths of extended families

- Things like respect and care for the elderly are important
- More family around to help with chores, child care, in case of emergencies, etc.
- Social support

Weaknesses of extended families

- Financial issues can occur if parents are supporting several other adults and children without any extra income

- Lack of secludedness depending on the living environment

Types of family: Childless family

- These are families with two partners who cannot have or don't want kids. In the world of family types and dynamics,

these families are often forgotten or left out. In the past, growing up, getting married, and having children was the

norm, but in today's world, more people are choosing to postpone having children or deciding not to have any. These

unique families include working couples who may have pets or enjoy taking on other people's kids (like nieces and

nephews) for the day occasionally rather than having their own. They could also be adventurous couples who don't feel

like kids would be a good fit for their lifestyle. These relationships can be between wife and husband, husband and

husband, wife and wife, or partner and partner.

Strengths of childless families

- Typically have more disposable income
- No dependents to take care of
- Have more freedom to travel, go on adventures, pursue different careers or education
- Couples get to spend more time together

Weaknesses of childless families

- Couples can feel isolated or left out when all their friends/family start having kids
- If you like kids, you can feel like something is missing
- Infertility can force a family to be childless, which can be hard for couples

Types of family: Stepfamily

- A stepfamily is when two separate families merge into one. This can go several different ways, like

two divorced parents with one or more children blending families, or one divorced parent with kids marrying someone who has never been married and has no kids.

Strengths of stepfamilies

- Children get the benefit of having two parents around
- Children and their new siblings or step-parents can form strong bonds
- The benefit of having two incomes compared to single-parent families

Weaknesses of stepfamilies

- Adjustment can be difficult for parents and children
- Parents can run into problems trying to discipline each other's kids
- May lack discipline or be inconsistent

Types of family: Grandparent

family

- This is when one or more grandparent is raising their grandchild or grandchildren.

Although not uncommon but it is on the rise. This situation happens when the parents aren't around to take care of their kids or are incapable of properly taking

care of their kids. It can be hard for grandparents to raise their grandchildren.

Strengths of grandparent families

- Grandparents and grandchildren form a close bond
- Keeps children from ending up in foster homes or other situations

Weaknesses of grandparent families

- Grandparents may not work or have full-time jobs, may struggle with income
- Depending on their health, it may be difficult for them to keep up with young children or discipline them as they get older

Changes in Family Structure

- As evidenced by the different types above, trends in family structures have changed in different ways over the years. One of these large changes has become the retreat of marriage and shift towards cohabitation between partners. Again, the research does not put this family above or below others, but some effects are unavoidable and being studied. With this, here are some resources on ways to increase success in cohabiting with a partner

Family Cont'd

Characteristics Functions

- There are conditions which must be met.
- Sexual satisfaction
- Procreation
- There must be a form of marriage.
- There must be mating and sexual relationship.
- Economic survival
- Child rearing
- There must be economic, social and cultural system uniting the family
- Educational function
- There must be a common home or habitation
- Legal function
- Productive function
- Recreational function

Social Pattern/structure

- Social structure is the aggregate of patterned social arrangements in society that are both emergent from and determinant of the actions of individuals. Likewise, society is believed to be grouped into structurally related groups or sets of roles, with different functions, meanings, or purposes.
- Examples of social structure include family, religion, law, economy, and class. It contrasts with "social system", which refers to the parent structure in which these various structures are embedded. Thus, social structures significantly influence larger systems, such as economic systems, legal systems, political systems, cultural systems, etc. Social structure can also be said to be the framework upon which a society is established. It determines the norms and patterns of relations between the various institutions of the society.

Types of social structure

- Institutional structure: "social structure is seen as comprising those cultural or normative patterns that define the expectations of agents hold about each other's behaviour and that organize their enduring relations with each other."
- Relational structure: "social structure is seen as comprising the relationships themselves, understood as patterns of causal interconnection and interdependence among agents and their actions, as well as the positions that they occupy."
- Microstructure: The pattern of relations between most basic elements of social life, that cannot be further divided and have no social structure of their own (e.g. pattern of relations between individuals in a group composed of individuals, where individuals have no social structure; or a structure of organizations as a pattern of relations between social positions or social roles, where those positions and roles have no structure by themselves).
- Macrostructure: The pattern of relations between objects that have their own structure (e.g. a political social structure between political parties, as political parties have their own social structure).

Social Structures/Pattern

- Social Pattern – The society has customs which provide rules for marriages, burial, naming ceremonies and chieftaincy affairs, inheritance of properties and security of tenants of lands. They also have laws and systems of education which they acquire from other people, changes in economy, increasing urbanization and political changes. Everything continues to change and this may have positive or negative effects on the health conditions. Health team in the community should organize discussion groups to think about implications and changes which occur in the community, Such as:
 - How best the changes in the population growth can be controlled.
 - The necessary technology that can be used to improve the standard of living in the community.
 - Health care in the community
 - Need for schools
 - Good road network
 - Housing estate

In conclusion, social amenities should be provided for everyone irrespective of religion, tribe or any other factor, in order to be able to fight ignorance, poverty, diseases and handicaps.

Political Pattern/Structure

- Political structure is a commonly used term in political science. In a general sense, it refers to institutions or even groups and their relations to each other, their patterns of interaction within political systems and to political regulations, laws and the norms present in political systems in such a way that they constitute the political landscape and the political entity. In the social domain, its counterpart is social structure. Political structure also refers to the

way in which a government is run.

Political Pattern/Structure Cont'd

- This is hierarchical for example the local government is responsible to the state government while the state government is responsible to the federal government.
- It is the political life of a nation that dictates the pattern in the community.
- People are involved in government through voting, paying taxes and by means of discussion in the political party forum. If there is political instability in a country, it will adversely affect the country's economy, education and the health condition of the people and people move from rural to urban but a stable government gives stable progress in the health field where there is future planning, training of personnel, good hospitals and services, health and food supply. Meanwhile, health workers should educate people on their health needs.

Cultural structures/Patterns

- A community has culture which gives guidelines to their way of life in a particular area. E.g. cultural believes with regards to dressing, eating, morals, etc. The health team is responsible for the necessary advice and if possible discouraged harmful cultural practices that are detrimental to health and encourage the good ones.
- A cultural pattern is an organized pattern of behavior. It represents a style of conduct that all members of a particular community or group share.
- Ideal cultural patterns and actual behavioral patterns are two different kinds of cultural patterns. Ideal cultural norms specify how members of a society ought to act in specific circumstances. But people occasionally behave differently from the ideal patterns that their society has established. Actual behavioral patterns describe how individuals actually act in specific circumstances.

Economic structures/Patterns

- The phrase "economic structure" refers to the shifting balance of output, trade, earnings, and employment across several economic sectors, ranging from primary (farming, fishing, mining, etc.) through secondary (manufacturing and construction industries) to tertiary and quaternary sectors (tourism, banking, software industries). Changes in an economic structure are an inevitable part of existence, but they pose obstacles in reallocating production factors.
- The factors of production, such as land, capital, labour, and physical resources, are regulated by economic systems. An economic system comprises a variety of organisations, agencies, companies, decision-making processes, and consumption patterns that make up a community's economic structure. Also, the pattern of riverine people will be different from people with people who are farmers.
- Whatever the changes that is taking place in the community, health workers must be involved, so as to ensure good and healthy living condition for their people.

Types of the Economic Structure

- **Traditional Economic System:** The traditional economic system is founded on exchanging goods, services, and labour, following well-established patterns. It is heavily reliant on individuals, with little division of labour or specialisation. The traditional economy is, in essence, the most fundamental and oldest of the four types.
- **Command Economic Structure:** In a command system, a powerful centralised authority – usually the government – is in charge of a large section of the economy. The command economic system, often known as a planned system, is widespread in communist regimes since the government makes production decisions.
- **Market Economic System:** The principle of free markets underpins market economic systems. To put it another way, the government plays a minor role. The government has little control over resources and avoids interfering with vital economic sectors. Rather, people and the supply-demand connection are the sources of regulation.
- **Mixed System:** The characteristics of the market and command economic systems are combined in mixed systems. As a result, mixed systems are often referred to as dual systems. The word is also used to characterise a market system that is heavily regulated.

HEALTH PATTERNS, FACTORS INFLUENCING HEALTH AND DISEASES.

- Health is a state of complete physical, mental and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity.
- Illness is a subjective term, it refers to symptoms which are perceived to be health related

HEALTH PATTERNS

- Go through the Gordon's Functional Health Patterns

FACTORS INFLUENCING HEALTH AND DISEASES.

- Genetic make up
- Lifestyle
- Socio-economic conditions/Poverty
- Education
- Occupation
- Health services
- Hereditary factor
- Environmental or physical factor
- Housing
- Adequate diet and food hygiene
- Rest and sleep
- Exercise
- Good posture

- Clothing
- Sexuality education

Modes of health promotion, accidents and disease prevention in the community.

- Health promotion is the process of enabling people to increase control over, and to improve their health.”
- It is a process of assisting individuals, acting separately or collectively to make informed decision on matters affecting individuals, family and community health.
- Health promotion seeks to improve the level of health in a population by preventing diseases, controlling hazards, improving fitness and well being and enhancing the capacity of workers to work and to function in society.
- Health promotion activities are generally divided into education, health protection (protecting the worker from hazards and ensuring prompt intervention if something goes wrong) and prevention of disease.

HEALTH PROMOTION INTERVENTIONS

- Health Education
- Environmental changes & modification
- Nutritional intervention
- Life style & behavioral changes
- Genetic counseling

HEALTH PROMOTION INTERVENTIONS

- Health Education - It is cost effective approach a. Many diseases can be prevented with little or no medical intervention if people are informed and encouraged to take necessary precautions against these diseases.
- ENVIRONMENTAL CHANGES / MODIFICATION Provision of safe water supply, Sanitary latrines installation, Insect and rodent control, Improvement of housing
- Nutritional interventions include: a. Food distribution and nutritional improvement of vulnerable groups. b. Proper weaning practices / child feeding programme. c. Food fortification d. Nutrition education – balanced diet.
- Life Style and behavioral changes : Health education is the basic element of all health activity. It is of paramount importance in changing the views, behavior and habits of people. Encouraging physical activity, hygiene and healthy life styles, Discouraging smoking, physical inactivity, addiction, Modifying diet patterns

SPECIFIC PROTECTION

- Idea is to avoid disease altogether. Currently available interventions includes:
 - i. Immunization
 - ii. Use of specific nutrients
 - iii. Chemoprophylaxis

- iv. Protection against occupational hazards
- v. Protection against accidents.
- vi. Protection from carcinogens vii. Avoidance of allergens viii. Better environmental conditions e.g. control of air and noise pollution
- ix. Control of consumer product quality and safety of foods, drugs, cosmetics

APPROACHES IN HEALTH PROMOTION

- Medical or Preventive
- Behaviour Change
- Educational
- Empowerment
- Social Change

THE MEDICAL APPROACH

- Aim is freedom from medically-defined disease and disability such as infectious diseases
- Involves medical intervention to prevent or ameliorate ill-health
- Values preventive medical procedures and the medical profession's responsibility to ensure that patients comply with recommended procedures

THE BEHAVIOUR CHANGE APPROACH

- Aim is to change people's individual attitudes and behaviour so that they adopt a healthy lifestyle
- Examples include teaching people how to stop smoking, encouraging people to take exercise, eat the right food, look after their teeth etc
- Proponent of this approach will be convinced that a healthy lifestyle is in the interest of their clients and that they are responsible to encourage as many people as possible to adopt a healthy lifestyle

THE EDUCATIONAL APPROACH

- Aim is to give information and ensure knowledge and understanding of health issues and to enable well informed decisions to be made
- Information about health is presented and people are helped to explore their values and attitudes and make their own decisions
- Help in carrying out those decisions and adopting new health practices may also be offered.
- Proponent of this approach will value the educational process and respect the right of the individual to choose their own health behaviour
- Responsibility to raise with clients the health issues which they think will be in their client's best interests

THE CLIENT-CENTRED APPROACH (EMPOWERMENT)

- Aim is to work with clients in order to help them to identify what they want to know about and take action on and make their own decisions and choices according to their own interest and values • Health promoter's role is to act as a facilitator in helping people to identify their own concerns and gain the knowledge and skills they require to make things happen.
- Self-empowerment of the client is seen as central to this aim • Clients are valued as equal who have knowledge, skills and abilities to contribute, and who have an absolute right to control their own health destinies

THE SOCIETAL CHANGE APPROACH

- Aim is to effect changes on the physical, social and economic environment, in order to make it more conducive to good health • Focus is on changing society not on changing the behavior of individuals • Proponent of this approach will value their democratic right to change society and will be committed to putting health on the political agenda

Accident

- This is an unexpected event, typically sudden in nature and associated with injury, loss, or harm.
- Accidents are a common feature of the human experience and result in injury or permanent disability to large numbers of people worldwide every year.
- Many accidents also involve damage to or loss of property.
- Accidents can occur anywhere, including in the home, during transportation, in the hospital, on the sports field, or in the workplace.
- With appropriate safety precautions and awareness of one's actions and environment, many accidents can be avoided or prevented.

Concepts in accident prevention

- Primary prevention: removal of circumstances causing injury - eg, traffic speed reduction, fitting stair gates for young children, reducing alcohol consumption.
- Secondary prevention: reduces severity of injury should an accident occur - eg, use child safety car seats, bicycle helmets, smoke alarms.
- Tertiary prevention: optimal treatment and rehabilitation following injuries to minimise long-term consequences - eg, effective first aid, appropriate hospital care.

Types of Accident

- Motor vehicle
- Accidents in the home

- Sport accident
- Accidents in the workplace
- Accidents in the hospital

Role of clinicians in accident prevention

- Advice to patients: health workers such as health visitors can sometimes be well placed to identify accident risks or medical conditions conferring risk and to advise accordingly
- Child accident prevention: Identify hazards (eg, if a family is being seen by a health visitor at home or if treatment is being sought for accidental injury).
- Advise about prevention - eg, stair gates, keeping chemicals out of reach, etc .

Role of clinicians in accident prevention Cont'd

- Patients with medical conditions :
- Identify and treat accident-causing conditions - eg, obstructive sleep apnoea, visual or balance disorders.
- Give appropriate advice on fitness to drive.
- Advise patients on how to minimise accident risks from their medical condition.
- Identify unacceptable risks and intervene where appropriate - for example:
- Identify vulnerable children and adults with recurrent injuries or at high risk. This includes those who are experiencing neglect and may require child protection procedures.
- Consider reporting to the Road Safety patients who fail to comply with medical driving regulations.
- Accident surveillance: health professionals and their organisations can monitor injury rates and report preventable accidents

Non-clinical interventions

- Advocacy and policy making.
- Collaboration with other agencies.
- Promoting accident prevention education and training.
- Research.

Safety

- Safety is a concept that relates to freedom from danger, injury, threat or risks, whether to life or property.

Importance of safety and safe living.

- Reduce the likelihood of injury and accident.
- It helps to provide safe and healthy living.
- It protects people from premature and unexpected death.
- It helps to create a civilized and progressive society.
- It helps to protect people from financial losses due to unnecessary responses to

accidents and injuries.

- It protects people from undue mental stress and tension.
- It creates safety behaviors and attitudes in people for a safe living.
- Safety helps to build healthy and safety-conscious individuals

DISEASE PREVENTION

- Prevention, in turn, is often divided into primary prevention (the prevention of disease in the first place, for example through clean water or immunization against infectious disease), secondary prevention (the early detection of disease at a stage when it can be treated or limited, through periodic health surveillance) and tertiary prevention (prevention of disability, for example by providing rehabilitation services after an injury).

Level of prevention

- Primordial prevention consists of actions to modify population health determinants and to inhibit the establishment of factors (environmental, economic, social, and behavioural) known to increase the risk of future disease. It targets determinants at the societal level rather than modifying personal risk factors, which is the focus of primary prevention. Thus, outlawing alcohol in certain countries would represent primordial prevention, whereas a campaign against drinking and driving would illustrate primary prevention.
- Other examples of primordial prevention include improving sanitation (to eliminate exposure to infectious agents), establishing healthy communities, promoting a healthy lifestyle in childhood (for example, through free school meals or early childhood development programmes), or developing green energy approaches.

Primary prevention

- It aims to prevent the onset of specific diseases via risk reduction – by altering behaviours or exposures that can lead to disease, or by enhancing resistance to the effects of a disease agent.
- It aims to reduce the incidence of disease; examples include vaccination and smoking cessation. Some approaches involve active participation, as with regular tooth brushing and flossing to prevent dental caries. Other approaches are passive: adding fluoride to the municipal drinking water to harden tooth enamel and prevent caries.
- It commonly targets specific agents and the risk factors for particular diseases.
- It aims to promote healthy behaviours, improve host resistance, and foster safe environments that reduce the risk of disease in general, for instance thorough cleaning of operating rooms to prevent post-operative infection.

Secondary prevention

- It includes procedures to detect and arrest pre-clinical pathological changes

and thereby control the progression of a disease. Screening procedures (such as mammography to detect early stage breast cancer) are often the first step, leading to early interventions that are more cost-effective than intervening once symptoms appear. Routine blood sugar testing for people over 40 would be an example relevant to detecting Catherine's diabetes early. Screening is usually undertaken by health professionals, either in individual doctor-patient encounters as with routine blood pressure checks, or via public health screening programs (e.g., population mammography screening programmes).

Tertiary prevention

- Seeks to soften the impact of the disease on the patient's function, longevity, and quality of life. Tertiary prevention approaches are often similar to primary, but they target patients, rather than healthy people. Examples include modifying behavioural risk factors, such as assisting a cardiac patient to lose weight, or making environmental modifications to reduce an asthmatic patient's exposure to allergens. For Catherine Richards, this might include regular check-ups to monitor her condition, including checks for possible adverse outcomes of her diabetes. The key goal for tertiary prevention is to maintain quality of life. Where a condition is not reversible, tertiary prevention focuses on rehabilitation, assisting the patient to accommodate to his disability.

Strategies of Health promotion

- Health communication helps people better understand health needs, equipping them for important individual health decisions. Taking verbal and written forms, health communication encourages healthful activities and improves health literacy. It also bridges understanding with cultural considerations about health. Flu vaccination posters, health screening brochures, and discussions with patients about heart disease are all health communications.
- Health education teaches people about different health conditions to bolster prevention or early treatment. These learning sessions are often focused on target populations. For example, poorer neighborhoods may be candidates for nutrition and physical activity lessons to prevent or combat Type 2 diabetes

Strategies of Health promotion

- Policy, systems, and environmental change (PSEs) round out the basic health promotion strategies. Policy change would include smoke-free entryways and safety equipment in the workplace. Systems change deals with the use of innovations, technologies, or certifications to change how health problems are solved. Environmental change works to solve population health challenges with more parks and nutritious food availability

5 Key Action Areas for Health Promotion

- Reorient health services. This works to improve the entire population's health and allow everyone to access health resources, whether sick or well.

- Create a supportive environment. Surroundings that support health make it easier to achieve optimal wellness. The goal is to foster an environment that physically and socially assists in health success. Eliminating harmful practices is also part of creating a supportive space.
- Develop personal skills. People have to understand pertinent health information to take the necessary steps to improve their own health. By knowing what could cause illness, individuals can proactively monitor and support their wellness.
- Strengthen community action. People living in the same area or with the same health concerns can bond together to advocate for policy changes and the development of new programs.
- Building healthy public policy. Activities funded or conducted by the government can increase awareness and provide resources and education to help people take control of their personal health.

The role of health education, environmental sanitation and maintenance of environmental health.

- Health education is a process by which an information is successfully impacted in such a way that the recipient is motivated to make use of the information for the promotion, protection and maintenance or restoration of his family's or his community's health

Health education has a key role to play in sustaining the environment

- Giving health education to people and drawing their attention to those behavioural practices, habits, cultural beliefs and taboos which could lead to health problems that emanates from poor environmental sanitation, poor waste disposal, air, water and environmental pollution.
- Creating attitudes that are apparently new in individuals, groups and society at large towards the environment.
- Motivating people to embrace positive lifestyle modification, changing from habits that pose threat to their environment and their well-being to those that makes the environment habitable.

Health education has a key role to play in sustaining the environment cont'd

IV. Ensuring that people living in each community in Nigeria appreciate their role in taking appropriate measures and action to improve their environment and maintain good health with their collective efforts.

V. Highlighting the persistent increase in environmental related problems, its causes, cost and effects on individual, and community.

vi. Creating awareness that enable people to be conscious about the physical, social and aesthetic aspect of their environment.

vii. To train inhabitants of each community in Nigeria with skills to identify and solve environment related problems

Environmental health

- It is a facet of public health that focuses on the relationship humans have with the environment. E.g Fresh air, clean water, shelter, and a stable climate
- It can also be defined as a division or branch of public health which is concerned with related aspects connecting both the natural and built environment, that may affect human health and are often required to be monitored or mitigated. In general, environmental health aims to benefit the health of humans by preventing human injuries and promoting well-being, as a science and practice. To elaborate, environmental health identifies and evaluates the sources of environmental exposures that may be hazardous. These hazardous exposures could be considered physical, chemical, or biological agents within the environment. In addition, these agents may exist in the air, water, food, soil, and other elements of the natural realm in which humans frequently interact with or rely on in daily life.

5 areas of environmental health and safety

- Water and sanitation
- Chemicals and radiation
- Air pollution
- Built environments
- Climate change

areas of environmental health and safety

- Water and sanitation
- Roughly 784 million people are still without access to clean drinking water.

Lack of access to safe water is a huge health concern for humans and can negatively affect the environment as people take drastic action to secure a water source.

- 2. Chemicals and radiation
- Toxic gases, pollutants, and radiation exist all around us. Yet, they have the potential to wreak havoc on the health of both humans and the environment.
- Pesticides, for example, expose farmworkers and their families to pesticide-induced diseases such as asthma and various cancers. An analysis of over 40 years of epidemiologic literature has found that exposure to agricultural pesticides increases brain cancer risk by up to 20%.

Areas of environmental health and safety

- 3. Air pollution - Environmental exposures to poisonous gases are harmful to plant life, animal life, and human respiratory systems. Some leading sources of air pollution include: Power plants and factories The burning of fossil fuels
- Industrial waste, Natural disasters like volcano eruptions and wildfires, Industrial factories and billions of cars are just two

contributors to the earth's declining air quality. About 85% of US energy comes from the industrial burning of fossil fuels, creating 50% of the pollution in America.

- 4. Built environments - Shelter forms a large part of human health and safety. But too many built developments can harm the environment. A poorly designed built environment produces unnecessary waste. It also consumes excessive amounts of water and energy.
- 5. Climate change - Considered the top threat to humanity in the 21st century, climate change disrupts the natural world in various dangerous ways. Natural disasters also fall into this category. The threat of climate change is continuously increasing.

Environmental health factors

- are the various things within the environment that affect human-beings health. Dangerous substances may come from different sources that originated from human development and industrialization, including agricultural activities, mining operations, landfills, underground storage tanks, shipping and transportation, carbon emissions, etc. All of these activities tend to produce hazardous substances which are left in the natural elements of air, soil, and water, which in turn impact the health of the environment.

Environmental health factors

- Physical Hazards
- Physical hazards include processes which occur in the natural environment and can potentially have a harmful impact on the health of humans. Some examples of physical hazards include:
 - Electricity
 - Heat
 - Heights
 - Noise
 - Vibration
 - Body stressing
 - Confined spaces

Environmental health factors

- Chemical Hazards
- A chemical hazard refers to a non-biological substance that has the potential to harm or cause a negative impact to the health and overall life of a human. Chemicals are found in everyday life, whether it be in someone's home, workplace, or in the air which can cause both short and long-term health effects when absorbed in the body. Chemical hazards may be flammable or combustible,

explosive, oxidizing, shock-sensitive, or may react violently with elements such as water and air. Here are some examples of chemical hazards:

- Toxins
- Carcinogens
- Teratogens
- Irritants
- Sensitizers

Environmental Health Issues

This refers to an important topic or problem related to the status of the environment and its impact on the safety and well-being of humans, generally such a topic is up for debate and discussion. Some examples of present day environmental health issues include:

- Climate change
- Pollution
- Deforestation
- Disease

Why is environmental health important?

- 1. Reduces risk of diseases - Over the past two years, we have seen the severe damage that harmful microbes and pathogens (such as the coronavirus pandemic) can cause. Environmental health awareness can prevent disease outbreaks and reduce the burden of disease.
- 2. Increases biodiversity and habitat protection - We need biodiversity for our ecosystems and animal kingdoms to thrive. By raising environmental health awareness, we can enforce better protection for the creatures and plants around us.

Why is environmental health important?

- 3. Enhances quality and length of life
- When all of the criteria for human life, such as food safety and shelter, are provided and maintained, length and quality of life increase.
- 4. Limits global warming
- The gradual increase of global temperatures is not something we can outrun. But there are specific measures that we can put in place to slow it down and find solutions. By reducing industrial emissions and waste, organizations can vastly improve environmental health and reduce their impact on global warming.

How can the environment affect our health?

- 1. Respiratory diseases

- Air-borne pollutants and toxins can filter into our lungs and cause severe respiratory diseases. Ensuring a high level of air quality will prevent these kinds of diseases.
- 2. Increased risk of waterborne diseases
 - Cholera, diarrhea, dysentery, hepatitis A, typhoid, and polio can all be transmitted by poor water and sanitation. People living in low-income communities are most at risk for infectious diseases, especially waterborne diseases.
- 3. Danger from natural disasters – Even the healthiest environment cannot escape the occasional natural disaster. But environmental health procedures can reduce their impact significantly.
- 4. Lack of nutrition - Lack of nutrition often looks like a lack of healthy and affordable grocery stores near homes. This is called a food desert. Without proper access to nutrient-dense food, our bodily systems cannot function optimally. Every human has a right to live in an environment that supports their health, not degrades it.

How to improve our environmental health

- 1. Reduce your carbon footprint
 - You can drastically reduce the amount of carbon you contribute to the atmosphere by choosing methods of travel other than a car or airplane. If possible, reduce your carbon footprint by walking to work or riding your bike.
- 2. Reduce, reuse, recycle
 - The world is densely populated with industrial factories that pump harmful CO₂ into the environment. Support the health of your environment by reusing the items you have and recycling wherever possible.

How to improve our environmental health

- 3. Grow your own fruits and vegetables
 - By learning how to grow your own food, you will learn valuable life skills. It is also therapeutic and a great avenue of self-care.
 - With this growing wellness trend, you'll simultaneously advocate for your health and your environment.
- 4. Be conscious of the products you use
 - Many of the products we use were made in factories that exploit both humans and the environment. You can choose to fight against this by being more intentional about your products

Sanitation

- It generally refers to the provision of facilities and services for the safe disposal of human urine and faeces. The word 'sanitation' also refers to the maintenance of hygienic conditions, through services such as

garbage collection and wastewater disposal."

IMPORTANCE OF ENVIRONMENTAL SANITATION

- 1. It plays a critical role in preventing the spread of diseases. Proper waste management, clean water supply, and improved sanitation facilities reduce the risk of waterborne and communicable diseases, ultimately safeguarding public health.
- 2. Effective environmental sanitation helps preserve ecosystems and biodiversity by minimizing pollution and contamination of water bodies, soil, and air. This contributes to the overall ecological balance and supports sustainable development.
- 3. It enhances the quality of life for individuals and communities, creating more livable and aesthetically pleasing surroundings.
- 4. It addresses environmental sanitation, we can mitigate the impact of climate change, as well-maintained ecosystems are better equipped to absorb shocks and provide climate resilience.

What are the 4 types of sanitation?

- **Personal Sanitation:** This refers to individual hygiene practices like handwashing, bathing, and oral care, which prevent the spread of diseases and maintain personal well-being.
- **Domestic Sanitation:** It involves proper waste disposal, clean water supply, and functional sanitation facilities within households to ensure a safe and healthy living environment.
- **Food Sanitation:** This encompasses practices that ensure the safety and hygiene of food from production to consumption, reducing the risk of foodborne illnesses.
- **Environmental Sanitation:** It addresses broader environmental concerns, including waste management, water treatment, and pollution control to safeguard public health and ecosystems.

maintenance of proper sanitation of the
environment

- **Landfilling stagnant water potholes:** This not only keeps the environment clean but also prevents the breeding of disease-causing mosquitoes.
- **Proper disposal of garbage:** This helps prevent hazardous waste from spreading diseases.
- **Providing sewage disposal systems:** This channelizes the waste material to proper disposal sites and prevents contamination of the environment.
- **Strict enforcement of anti-pollution, and other environment-friendly laws by Central and State pollution control boards:** These assist in setting parameters to prevent the pollution and degradation of the environment and thereby keep the environment clean.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 1. Educate and raise awareness:
 - Individuals who are well-informed are the foundation of effective change. Launching awareness campaigns and educational initiatives is the first step towards improving environmental sanitation. Education about proper sanitation methods should begin early in a child's development to instill these good practices in their behavior. Organize workshops, seminars, and interactive sessions to emphasize the close relationship between cleanliness and public health. Today, leveraging the influence of digital platforms and social media to spread information on waste management techniques, proper hygiene practices, and the overall consequences of environmental negligence is a much easier and smarter way to solve this problem.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 2. Implement Strong Waste Management Systems:
 - A cornerstone of improved environmental sanitation is an efficient waste management system. Collaborate with local authorities to establish a comprehensive waste collection and disposal mechanism. Implement a system that includes separate bins for recyclables, organic waste, and non-recyclables. The importance of regular waste collection and proper disposal methods cannot be overstated. Encourage community members to sort their waste at the source, streamlining recycling processes and minimizing waste generation. Setting up a common waste segregation system in societies can be a critical step towards effective waste management.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 3. Encourage recycling and upcycling:
 - Promoting the practice of recycling and upcycling can significantly reduce waste accumulation. Create accessible recycling centers where residents can deposit their recyclable materials. Forge partnerships with local recycling companies or organizations to ensure the proper processing of collected materials. Arrange workshops, exhibitions, or interactive events that showcase innovative ways to repurpose everyday items, inspiring a more conscious and sustainable way of living.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 4. Implement Effective Composting Practices:

- Composting is not only an eco-friendly solution but also an opportunity to enrich the soil and promote sustainable gardening practices. Encourage individuals to compost kitchen waste, yard clippings, and other organic materials. Provide detailed guidance on setting up composting bins, identifying compostable materials, and illustrating the advantages of integrating compost into community gardens or personal landscapes.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

• 5. Cultivate Community Gardens:

- Community gardens serve as a multifaceted solution to environmental sanitation. They offer an opportunity to reclaim open spaces, cultivate a sense of communal involvement, and enable residents to grow their own fresh produce. Organize workshops on effective gardening techniques, composting practices, and sustainable agricultural methods. These gardens can also act as educational hubs, enlightening children and adults about the environment, food production, and sustainability.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

• 6. Promote Clean Water Practices:

- Accessible clean water is foundational to maintaining proper hygiene. Collaborate with local authorities to ensure consistent access to safe and clean drinking water. Educate community members about the significance of water conservation, prompt leak detection and repair, and responsible water consumption. Swiftly address any concerns related to water pollution and embark on initiatives to safeguard local water sources.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

• 7. Eradicate Open Defecation:

- Open defecation is a glaring contributor to poor environmental sanitation. Team up with local authorities and community leaders to encourage the construction and utilization of sanitary toilets. Initiate awareness campaigns that underscore the health hazards of open defecation and disseminate information regarding available sanitation facilities. A great alternative to making toilets accessible in difficult terrain and public places is installing portable toilets. Companies like Re-leaf offer sturdy portable toilets made out of high-quality materials that can be easily installed in places where constructing toilets is difficult.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 8. Mobilize Cleanup Drives:

- Regular cleanup drives are pivotal in maintaining the cleanliness of public spaces. Energize community members to actively participate in these initiatives, which involve collecting litter from streets, parks, and recreational areas. These efforts not only enhance the visual appeal of the neighborhood but also inculcate a sense of ownership and accountability among residents.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 9. Engage in Afforestation and Green Initiatives:

- The significance of trees and green spaces cannot be overstated in maintaining a harmonious ecosystem. Launch afforestation projects that bolster the green cover in your community. Opt for indigenous trees that thrive in the local climate, thus promoting biodiversity. Beyond their aesthetic value, these trees improve air quality, provide shelter for wildlife, and contribute to the overall ecological balance.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 10. Forge Collaborations with Local Stakeholders:

- Environmental sanitation necessitates collective action. Partner with local authorities, businesses, NGOs, and other stakeholders to pool resources, knowledge, and expertise. Collaborative efforts can yield innovative waste management systems, cleaner public spaces, and sustainable solutions to environmental challenges.

- 11. Continuously Monitor and Evaluate Progress:

- Consistent monitoring and evaluation are critical to assessing the efficacy of your environmental sanitation endeavors. Track key metrics, including waste generation rates, water quality, and community participation levels. Employ this data to pinpoint areas that need improvement and refine your strategies accordingly.

Improving Environmental Sanitation in Your Community

- 12. Celebrate Milestones and Sustain Efforts:

- Acknowledging achievements is essential for sustaining momentum. Celebrate the strides your community has made in enhancing environmental sanitation. Organize celebratory events, share inspiring success stories, and extend recognition to individuals and groups who have made noteworthy contributions. To maintain progress, ensure a continued commitment to long-term change by orchestrating regular

events, workshops, and campaigns.

Health surveillance, motivation and community participation in the control of communicable diseases

- Health surveillance is a scheme of repeated health checks which are used to identify ill health caused by work. Health and safety law requires health surveillance when your workers remain exposed to health risks even after you have put controls in place
- Health surveillance is any activity that involves getting information about an employee's health to help protect them from health risks at work. Some are required by law (health surveillance) and others are carried out as good practice (health checks).
- Workplace control measures may not always be totally reliable.

Carrying out health surveillance can help make sure that any potential ill health effects are detected as early as possible.

- Objectives
- To proactively screen to detect early signs of work affecting employees' health.
- To protect the health of employees by detecting ill-health effects as early as possible.
- To assess the effectiveness of measures to control exposure.

health surveillance

It can include various types of tests: Health surveillance may be appropriate if:

- Skin examination. • it does not pose a risk to the employee
- Hand and arm, or full-body, vibration tests (HAVS). • there is a suitable test available to detect the level of exposure
- Lung function tests – such as peak flow and spirometry. • there is a potential risk of a workplace exposure that may be hazardous to health
- Hearing or vision tests – such as audiology or keystone. • exposure to potential workplace health hazards have been reported or can be detected
- Medical tests – such as blood, urine, ECG and blood pressure
- Physical tests – such as musculoskeletal, dexterity, function, height and weight.
- Confidential health questionnaires which are industry-specific and require a detailed recorded history.

Types of surveillance

- Passive surveillance
- Passive surveillance often gathers disease data from all potential reporting health care workers. Health authorities do not stimulate reporting by reminding health care workers to report disease nor providing feedback to individual health workers.
- Passive surveillance is the most common type of surveillance in humanitarian emergencies. Most surveillance for communicable diseases is passive. The surveillance coordinator may provide training to health workers in how to complete the surveillance forms, and may even send someone to periodically collect forms from health facilities. But little attention is given to individual health workers who report the information.

Types of surveillance

- Active surveillance
- An active surveillance system provides stimulus to health care workers in the form of individual feedback or other incentives. Often reporting frequency by individual health workers is monitored; health workers who consistently fail to report or complete the forms incorrectly are provided specific feedback to improve their performance. There may also be incentives provided for complete reporting.
- Active surveillance requires substantially more time and resources and is therefore less commonly used in emergencies. But it is often more complete than passive surveillance. It is often used if an outbreak has begun or is suspected to keep close track of the number of cases. Community health workers may be asked to do active case finding in the community in order to detect those patients who may not come to health facilities for treatment.

Types of surveillance

- Sentinel surveillance
- Instead of attempting to gather surveillance data from all health care workers, a sentinel surveillance system selects, either randomly or intentionally, a small group of health workers from whom to gather data. These health workers then receive greater attention from health authorities than would be possible with universal surveillance.
- Sentinel surveillance also requires more time and resources, but can often produce more detailed data on cases of illness because the health care workers have agreed to participate and may receive incentives. It may be the best type of surveillance if more intensive investigation of each case is necessary to collect the necessary data.

Steps in carrying out surveillance

- Reporting
- Someone has to record the data. This is usually health care providers who provide clinical care, such as doctors, nurses, clinical officers, etc. They complete a form recording various bits of information about patients seen in their practice.
- Data accumulation
- Someone has to be responsible for collecting the data from all the reporters and putting it all together. This is often someone in the Ministry of Health, the local health authorities, or the organization coordinating surveillance.
- Data analysis
- Someone has to look at the data to calculate rates of disease, changes in disease rates, etc. This is often an epidemiologist with specific data analysis and computer skills.
- Judgment and action
- Someone has to decide, based on the results of analysis, what needs to be done. This is often the public health authorities at the local, provincial, or national level. In emergencies, it is often a joint opinion of local and national health authorities, the organization coordinating health, and all the organizations providing health services.

Community Participation

- This is the process by which individuals and families assume responsibility for their own health and of the community they live in. This is the one of the strategies of primary health care. The community is involved right from the planning stage of a programme to implementation and even evaluation stage, thus decision-making process is revolved around the community.
- Community participation involves both theory and practice related to the direct involvement of citizens or citizen action groups potentially affected by or interested in a decision or action.

ADVANTAGES OF COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION

- It allows communities to exert effective administrative supervision over health services
- It makes use of part time unremunerated community/village health workers
- It improves coverage and access to healthcare
- It improves communication between the population and the health services.
- It promotes local insurance scheme for purchasing pharmaceutical products.

SOCIO-CULTURAL FACTORS THAT CAN AFFECT COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION

- Unfavourable socio-political factors
- Rural poor communities and landless workers
- Government showing concern for the rural development and

improvement of living standards in rural areas.

- Local people and NGO's showing initiative for health care
- Repression of trade unions

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Paper 3 of 7 — CAUSES AND PREVENTION OF VIOLENCE - NSG 501

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

DEPARTMENT OF NURSING SCIENCE,
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NSG 501

UNIT VI; FAMILY AND COMMUNITY VIOLENCE
GROUP 3

TOPIC; CAUSES AND PREVENTION OF VIOLENCE

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INTRODUCTION

Violence is a relatively common type of human behaviour that occurs throughout the world. People of any age may be violent, although older adolescents and young adults are most likely to engage in violent behaviour. Violence has a number of negative effects on those who witness or experience it, and children are especially susceptible to its harm. Fortunately, various programs have been successful at preventing and reducing violence.

CAUSES OF VIOLENCE

Violence within families and communities remains a significant societal concern, impacting individuals' physical, emotional, and social well-being. Understanding the causes and implementing preventive measures are critical to addressing this issue.

Causes of Violence includes;

1. INDIVIDUAL FACTORS:

Mental Health Disorders: Conditions like depression, anxiety, and personality

disorders may lead to aggression and violent outbursts.

Substance Abuse: Excessive alcohol consumption and drug use often impair judgment and increase violent tendencies.

History of Trauma: Individuals who have experienced abuse, neglect, or exposure to violence in childhood are more likely to exhibit violent behavior later in life.

2. FAMILY-RELATED CAUSES:

Dysfunctional Family Dynamics: Poor communication, unresolved conflicts, and emotional neglect can contribute to a toxic family environment.

Intergenerational Violence: Witnessing or experiencing violence within the family often perpetuates a cycle of violence across generations.

Economic Hardship: Financial stress, poverty, and unemployment increase tension and conflict within families, often escalating to violence.

3. COMMUNITY-RELATED CAUSES:

Social Inequality: Marginalization, lack of access to basic services, and economic disparities foster resentment and conflict in communities.

Prevalence of Crime: High crime rates, gang activities, and weak law enforcement exacerbate community violence.

Cultural Norms: Acceptance or glorification of violence in certain cultures or traditions normalizes aggressive behavior.

4. SOCIETAL FACTORS:

Gender Inequality: Patriarchal systems and societal norms that devalue women's rights often result in domestic and gender-based violence.

Media Influence: Frequent exposure to violent movies, video games, and social media content can desensitize individuals and promote aggressive behaviors.

Inadequate Legal Systems: Weak judicial frameworks and lack of enforcement allow violence to persist with impunity.

PREVENTION OF VIOLENCE

Preventing violence involves a combination of strategies aimed at addressing the root causes, such as poverty, inequality, discrimination, and lack of education. Effective approaches focus on both individual and community levels, fostering resilience, improving social conditions, and promoting peace. These can include:

1. EDUCATION AND AWARENESS:

Implement educational programs to teach children and adults about non-violent conflict resolution, communication, and empathy.

Conduct campaigns in schools and communities to raise awareness about the impact of violence and how to prevent it.

2. PROMOTING GENDER EQUALITY:

Empower women and girls through education and economic opportunities to reduce the likelihood of gender-based violence.

Encourage shared responsibility in households and communities, reducing power imbalances.

3. BUILDING STRONGER COMMUNITIES:

Strengthen community ties and encourage collective problem-solving.

Support neighbourhood groups, local initiatives, and grassroots organizations that work towards peaceful resolutions.

4. ACCESS TO MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES:

Ensure that communities have access to mental health resources, including counselling and therapy services, to help individuals cope with stress and trauma, which can otherwise contribute to violent behaviour.

Offer crisis intervention and counselling services for those at risk of perpetrating or being victims of violence.

5. SUPPORT FOR AT-RISK YOUTH:

Provide mentorship programs, after-school activities, and safe spaces to steer at-risk youth away from violence.

Engage them in skills-building programs that offer educational and employment opportunities.

6. ECONOMIC AND EMPLOYMENT SUPPORT:

Focus on economic empowerment, including job training, fair wages, and job security, as poverty and lack of opportunity can contribute to violent behaviour.

Provide financial support programs that reduce inequality and stress.

7. STRONG LEGAL FRAMEWORKS AND ENFORCEMENT:

Strengthen laws that protect individuals from violence (e.g., domestic violence and child abuse) and ensure swift and fair enforcement of these laws.

Provide legal aid for victims to ensure they have access to justice.

8. EARLY INTERVENTION AND FAMILY SUPPORT:

Early identification of families at risk of violence and providing necessary interventions such as family therapy and parenting support programs.

Train health professionals to recognize signs of domestic violence or abuse and intervene early.

9. MEDIA AND SOCIAL MEDIA CAMPAIGNS:

Use media platforms to promote positive behaviour, conflict resolution, and social justice.

Engage celebrities and influencers to speak out against violence and encourage peace.

10. POLICY ADVOCACY AND REFORM:

Advocate for stronger, clearer policies that address violence, including better support for victims, stricter laws, and improved law enforcement training.

Involve policymakers in creating comprehensive violence prevention programs that involve public health, education, and criminal justice sectors.

11. CULTURAL AND RELIGIOUS LEADERS ENGAGEMENT:

Involve community leaders such as religious figures, cultural representatives, and local influencers in promoting non-violent behaviour.

Encourage discussions and dialogue around cultural beliefs and practices that could

perpetuate violence and provide alternatives.

12. DEVELOPING SAFE SPACES FOR VULNERABLE GROUPS:

Create shelters and safe spaces for individuals at risk of violence, such as victims of domestic violence, refugees, or marginalized groups.

Promote community centers as safe spaces where people can seek help and support.

13. RESTORATIVE JUSTICE PROGRAMS:

Implement restorative justice programs that focus on healing rather than punishment, offering victims the opportunity to meet with offenders in a controlled, mediated environment.

These strategies work together to prevent violence across multiple levels, from individual behaviour to systemic change. They aim to address both the symptoms and root causes of violence, ensuring a holistic approach to prevention.

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Paper 4 of 7 — PUBLIC - COMMUNITY HEALTH NURSING II COURSE CODE: NSG 501

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF NURSING SCIENCE

TYPOLOGY OF VIOLENCE : SELF-INFLICTED,
INTERPERSONAL AND COLLECTIVE VIOLENCE

COURSE: PUBLIC - COMMUNITY HEALTH NURSING II

COURSE CODE: NSG 501

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INTRODUCTION

- Violence is often defined as the use of physical force or power by humans to cause harm and degradation to other living beings, such as humiliation, pain, injury, disablement, damage to property and ultimately death, as well as destruction to a society's living environment. The World Health Organization (WHO) defines violence as "the intentional use of physical force or power, threatened or actual, against oneself, another person, or against a group or community, which either results in or has a high likelihood of resulting in injury, death, psychological harm, maldevelopment, or deprivation."
- Violence is a pervasive global phenomenon that adversely impacts individuals, families, communities, and entire societies. Recognized by the World Health Organization (WHO) as a significant public health issue, violence is classified into three broad categories based on its perpetrators and victims: self-inflicted violence, interpersonal violence, and collective violence. Each of these types has distinct characteristics, underlying causes, and consequences, requiring multifaceted

strategies for prevention and management.

TYPOLOGY OF VIOLENCE

1. Self-Inflicted Violence

Self-inflicted violence refers to deliberate actions by an individual aimed at causing harm to themselves. It ranges from self-harming behaviors to suicide, which is one of the leading causes of death worldwide.

Forms of Self-Inflicted Violence

- **Non-Suicidal Self-Injury (NSSI):** This includes behaviors such as cutting, burning, or other forms of physical harm without suicidal intent. These actions are often coping mechanisms for emotional distress or psychological pain.
- **Suicidal Behavior:** Includes suicidal ideation (thoughts of ending one's life), suicide attempts, and completed suicide. According to WHO, suicide accounted for over 700,000 deaths in 2021 globally, highlighting its prevalence.

Underlying Causes and Risk Factors

- **Psychological Factors:** Conditions like depression, anxiety, bipolar disorder, and schizophrenia are strongly associated with self-inflicted violence.
- **Social and Environmental Factors:** Loneliness, social isolation, financial stress, and experiences of abuse or trauma significantly increase vulnerability.
- **Biological Factors:** Research suggests a genetic predisposition to suicidal tendencies, as well as neurochemical imbalances such as low serotonin levels.

Impacts on Society and Individuals:

- A. **Health Consequences:** Individuals may experience chronic pain, infections, or permanent disabilities from self-inflicted injuries.
- B. **Economic Costs:** Healthcare systems bear significant costs due to emergency treatments and long-term care for survivors of suicide attempts.
- C. **Social Burden:** Families and communities face grief, stigma, and reduced productivity.

2. Interpersonal Violence

Interpersonal violence involves harm inflicted by one individual or group on another. It is one of the most visible forms of violence, often occurring in private or public domains.

Subtypes of Interpersonal Violence

- **Family and Intimate Partner Violence (IPV):** This includes physical, emotional, psychological, or sexual abuse within familial or intimate relationships. IPV is a gendered issue, with women disproportionately affected.
- **Child Abuse:** Encompasses physical abuse, sexual exploitation, neglect, and emotional maltreatment of children, often resulting in lifelong trauma.
- **Elder Abuse:** Neglect or harm inflicted upon older adults, often by caregivers or relatives, is an underreported but significant issue.
- **Community Violence:** Encompasses acts of aggression such as assaults, robberies, and gang-related violence occurring in public spaces.

Contributing Factors

- **Individual-Level Factors:** Substance abuse, mental illness, and personal histories of exposure to violence are key contributors.
- **Relationship-Level Factors:** Dysfunctional family dynamics, economic stress, and lack of communication exacerbate interpersonal violence.
- **Societal Factors:** Cultural norms that tolerate or glorify violence, weak judicial systems, and social inequalities contribute to its prevalence.

Impacts of Interpersonal Violence

- **Physical Consequences:** Injuries ranging from minor cuts to fatal outcomes. Women and children often face reproductive health issues due to sexual violence.
- **Mental Health Consequences:** Survivors frequently suffer from post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), depression, and anxiety, limiting their ability to lead fulfilling lives.
- **Economic Impact:** Loss of productivity, increased healthcare expenses, and judicial costs place a heavy financial burden on individuals and nations.

3. Collective Violence

Collective violence refers to the use of violence by groups to achieve political, social, or economic goals. This form of violence often arises from deep-seated structural issues and ideologies, leading to significant harm at both local and global levels.

Forms of Collective Violence

- **Political Violence:** Includes acts such as terrorism, war, genocide, and political repression. Armed conflicts often stem from disputes over territory, resources, or governance.
- **Economic Violence:** Structural violence, such as policies or practices that marginalize specific groups economically, leads to poverty, forced labor, and exploitation.
- **Social Violence:** Hate crimes, mob violence, and violence rooted in discrimination based on race, religion, gender, or ethnicity fall under this category.

Root Causes and Dynamics

- **Political and Governance Issues:** Weak governance, corruption, and lack of accountability often fuel political violence and conflicts.
- **Economic Inequality:** Disparities in wealth distribution and resource allocation often trigger economic and social unrest.
- **Social Divisions:** Cultural and religious intolerance, as well as systemic discrimination, exacerbate tensions within societies.

Consequences of Collective Violence

- **Humanitarian Crisis:** Wars and genocides result in mass casualties, displacement, and refugee crises.
- **Economic Devastation:** Destruction of infrastructure, businesses, and agricultural systems disrupts economic stability.
- **Long-Term Social Consequences:** Societies scarred by collective violence often grapple with cycles of revenge, mistrust, and weakened institutions.

Interrelation Between Types of Violence

While these typologies are distinct, they often intersect. For instance, individuals exposed to interpersonal violence during childhood may develop self-harming behaviors or perpetuate violence in adulthood. Similarly, collective violence can exacerbate interpersonal violence through displacement, resource scarcity, and weakened social systems.

Strategies for Addressing Violence

- **Public Health Approach:** Promoting mental health services, substance abuse treatment, and community support networks to address self-inflicted and interpersonal violence.
- **Strengthening Legal Frameworks:** Enforcing laws against domestic violence, child abuse, and hate crimes to deter perpetrators.
- **Educational Programs:** Raising awareness about non-violent conflict resolution and gender equality to challenge societal norms.
- **Conflict Resolution Mechanisms:** Negotiations, peace-building efforts, and equitable resource distribution to prevent collective violence.

CONCLUSION

Violence, whether self-inflicted, interpersonal, or collective, represents a significant threat to global health, security, and development. Addressing this complex issue requires a comprehensive understanding of its typology, root causes, and impacts, as well as a coordinated effort among governments, organizations, and communities. By targeting interventions to the specific dynamics of each type, societies can work towards a safer and more equitable future.

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Paper 5 of 7 — NATURE OF VIOLENCE (PHYSICAL, SEXUAL, PSYCHOLOGICAL AND DEPRIVATION)- NSG 501

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF NURSING SCIENCE

NSG 501

PUBLIC - COMMUNITY HEALTH NURSING II

LECTURER: MRS FAFOWORA

TOPIC: NATURE OF VIOLENCE (PHYSICAL, SEXUAL,
PSYCHOLOGICAL AND DEPRIVATION)

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WHAT IS VIOLENCE?

Violence is a pervasive issue that encompasses intentional use of force or power, whether physical, psychological, or social, resulting in harm to individuals or communities. It manifests in various forms and has significant physical, emotional, and social consequences. Below is a detailed exploration of violence by its types: physical, sexual, psychological, and deprivation.

NATURE OF VIOLENCE

1. PHYSICAL VIOLENCE

Physical violence involves the intentional use of physical force against another person or group that results in bodily harm, injury, or death. It is one of the most visible and recognized forms of violence.

Physical abuse

Physical abuse is deliberately aggressive or violent behavior by one person toward another that results in bodily injury.

It is most frequently observed in relationships of trust, particularly between parents and children

or between intimate partners (e.g., in a marriage or other relationship).

Individuals who experience physical abuse often feel helpless and isolated and are prone to the subsequent development of numerous pathological conditions, including depression, eating disorders, PTSD, anxiety disorders, and substance use problems.

CHARACTERISTICS

- Direct harm such as hitting, kicking, or slapping.
- Use of objects or weapons to inflict pain or injury.
- Actions like pushing, choking, or restraining.

Examples

- Domestic violence (e.g., spouse battering).
- Child abuse, including corporal punishment.
- Assaults in social or institutional settings.

CONSEQUENCES

- Physical: Fractures, bruises, internal injuries, or death.
- Psychological: Trauma, anxiety, post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD).
- Social: Stigmatization, loss of trust, and family breakdown.

2. SEXUAL VIOLENCE

Sexual violence involves any sexual act, attempt to obtain a sexual act, or other acts directed against a person's sexuality using coercion, force, or manipulation, regardless of the relationship with the victim.

Sexual violence is any intentional act of a sexual nature that is forced on another person, regardless

of their relationship, through physical force, coercion, intimidation, humiliation, causing or taking advantage of another's drug or alcohol intoxication, or taking advantage of another person's inability to consent. Sexual violence includes:

Examples:

Rape

Unwanted touching

Sexual harassment

Unwanted sexual comments

Threats of violence as related to sexual violence

Threats of other consequences such as job loss

Child sexual abuse

Stalking

Forced prostitution or human trafficking.

Sexual assault can happen to anyone regardless of age, race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, religion, geographic location, ability or social status.

Attempted or completed acts of a sexual nature without the active consent of all parties are criminal acts

CHARACTERISTICS

- Can occur in intimate, familial, or societal settings.
- Often involves power dynamics or exploitation.
- Includes verbal harassment and physical acts.

Examples

- Rape and sexual assault.
- Child sexual abuse or exploitation.
- Sexual harassment in workplaces or schools.
- Human trafficking for sexual exploitation.

CONSEQUENCES

- Physical: Injuries, sexually transmitted infections (STIs), unwanted pregnancies.
- Psychological: Depression, shame, guilt, low self-esteem.
- Social: Marginalization, stigma, and difficulty maintaining relationships.

3. PSYCHOLOGICAL VIOLENCE

Psychological violence involves behavior that causes emotional or mental harm to an individual, impacting their self-esteem, mental health, or overall well-being. It often accompanies other forms of violence, particularly physical and sexual violence. also known as emotional abuse, is a form of abuse that can have serious and lasting effects on a person's mental health. It can involve verbal abuse, such as yelling, name-calling, insults, and threats. It can also involve manipulation, such as gaslighting, which is when a person manipulates another person into doubting their memories or perception of reality.

Another form of psychological violence is controlling behaviour, such as monitoring or limiting a person's communication and movement. This can include controlling whom they can talk to, where they can go, and what they can do. It can also involve isolating the person from their friends, family, and support systems.

Psychological abuse involves the regular and deliberate use of a range of words and non-physical actions used with the purpose to manipulate, hurt, weaken or frighten a person mentally and emotionally; and/or distorting, confusing or influencing a person's thoughts and actions within their everyday lives, changing their sense of self and harming their wellbeing.

The effects of psychological violence can be severe and long-lasting. It can lead to mental health issues such as depression, anxiety, and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD). It can also affect a person's self-esteem and self-worth, causing them to feel hopeless, helpless, and worthless. This not only leads to mental health problems but also severe physical problems, such as psychosomatic disorders. This includes, but is not limited to;

- expressive aggression (e.g., humiliating and degrading)
- threats of physical or sexual violence
- control of reproductive or sexual health

It affects individual health and social networks and deprives them of opportunities for future personal, social and economic development.

Psychological abuse that involved abusive behaviour

- Belittle or humiliate you in public or private.

CHARACTERISTICS

- Subtle or overt manipulation and control.
- Use of threats, intimidation, or humiliation.
- Often chronic, making it difficult to recognize initially.

EXAMPLES

- Verbal abuse, such as name-calling or insults.
- Threats of harm to the individual or their loved ones.
- Controlling behaviors, such as isolating someone from friends and family.
- Gaslighting—manipulating someone into doubting their reality.

CONSEQUENCES

- Mental health issues: Anxiety, depression, PTSD.
- Emotional impact: Loss of confidence, feelings of worthlessness.
- Social effects: Isolation, difficulty forming or maintaining relationships.

4. VIOLENCE OF DEPRIVATION

What is deprivation?

Deprivation can refer to a lack of basic needs, such as food, clothing, housing, and education. It can also refer to inadequate social, environmental, and working conditions.

Deprivation has been distinguished from poverty because it refers to specific physical, environmental and social conditions, rather than general resource deficits. A person's own feeling of deprivation arises out of the comparison of his or her situation with those of better off persons (Chakravarty and Mukherjee, 1999). However, this distinction between poverty and deprivation is not always clear. For example, child poverty is sometimes measured in terms of deprivation. This approach "establishes a set of basic services and capabilities and then measures the number of children who do not have access to this same 'basket' of services and capabilities" (Minujin et al., 2006: 482).

Deprivation may also take many different forms. People can be said to be deprived if they lack the types of diet, clothing, housing, household facilities and fuel and environmental, educational, working and social conditions, activities and facilities which are customary, or at least widely encouraged and approved, in the societies to which they belong (Townsend, 1987: 125).

Deprivation and violence are linked in a complex way, with poverty and inequality being factors that can contribute to violence

Violence can be high in deprived communities because people may be willing to exploit others when they are unable to meet their basic needs. This can create a cycle of violence, where violence deflects exploitation to others, which then incentivizes more violence.

DEPRIVATION VIOLENCE occurs when individuals or groups are denied access to essential resources, opportunities, or services necessary for their survival, dignity, and development.

Poverty and child abuse

International research has found links between poverty and child neglect and abuse. However, most families living in poverty do not abuse their children.

CHARACTERISTICS

- Structural or systemic in nature.
- Often results from deliberate policies, neglect, or exploitation.
- Affects marginalized groups disproportionately.

Examples

- Denial of food, shelter, or healthcare.
- Preventing access to education or employment opportunities.
- Systematic poverty or economic exploitation.
- Human rights violations, such as withholding medical care in conflict zones.

CONSEQUENCES

- Physical: Malnutrition, illness, and death.
- Psychological: Hopelessness, chronic stress, and despair.
- Social: Perpetuation of inequality, cycles of poverty, and reduced community cohesion.

CONCLUSION

Violence, in all its forms—physical, sexual, psychological, and deprivation—has profound implications on individuals and societies. Recognizing its nature and interconnections is the first step toward creating safer, healthier, and more equitable communities. Comprehensive efforts involving education, legal reforms, and social support are essential to reduce its prevalence and impact.

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Paper 6 of 7 — PUBLIC HEALTH PREVENTION OF VIOLENCE(NSG 501)

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY, OSOGBO

FACULTY OF NURSING

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNITY HEALTH

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LEVEL:500

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INTRODUCTION

Violence is a significant public health concern, and its prevention requires a systematic, multi-level approach. Public health prevention strategies focus on reducing the risk factors and enhancing protective factors to prevent violence from occurring or recurring.

PUBLIC HEALTH PREVENTION STRATEGIES

These strategies are categorized into primary, secondary, and tertiary prevention.

Primary Prevention (Preventing Violence Before It Occurs):

- Primary prevention aims to prevent violence before it occurs by addressing root causes and risk factors at the population level. It focuses on creating environments that reduce the likelihood of violent behaviors developing.

Key Strategies:

- Education and Awareness Campaigns: Teaching non-violent conflict resolution, communication skills, and emotional regulation in schools and communities.
- Policy and Legislation: Enacting and enforcing laws on gun control, domestic

violence, and child protection.

- **Promoting Positive Social Norms:** Campaigns to challenge harmful norms like gender inequality, toxic masculinity, and cultural acceptance of violence.
- **Economic Support and Poverty Reduction:** Providing economic support and opportunities to reduce stressors that can lead to violence.
- **Strengthening Parenting Skills:** Parenting programs to promote positive child-rearing practices and prevent child abuse.
- **Early Childhood Interventions:** Programs like preschool education, social-emotional learning, and developmental support.

Examples

- Anti-bullying campaigns in schools.
- Policies promoting gender equality.
- Community development programs reducing poverty and unemployment.

Secondary Prevention (Immediate Response to Violence)

- Secondary prevention focuses on the early detection and intervention after violence has occurred to prevent its escalation and recurrence. It targets individuals and groups at higher risk of experiencing or perpetrating violence.

Key Strategies:

- **Crisis Intervention Services:** Providing immediate support to victims, such as emergency shelters and hotlines.
- **Screening and Risk Assessment:** Routine screening for domestic violence and child abuse in healthcare settings.
- **Conflict Mediation Programs:** Programs that mediate disputes to prevent violence from escalating.
- **Targeted Counseling Services:** Trauma-informed counseling for victims and perpetrators.

Examples:

- Domestic violence hotlines.
- Hospital-based violence intervention programs.
- Conflict resolution sessions in schools.

Tertiary Prevention (Long-term Response and Rehabilitation)

- Tertiary prevention focuses on providing long-term care and rehabilitation for victims and perpetrators of violence. It aims to reduce long-term harm and prevent the recurrence of violence.

Key Strategies:

- **Rehabilitation Programs for Perpetrators:** Programs designed to change violent behavior patterns through counseling and education.
- **Long-term Support for Victims:** Psychological counseling, medical care, and social services for trauma recovery.

- Restorative Justice Programs: Facilitating reconciliation between victims and perpetrators through mediated dialogue.
- Community Reintegration Programs: Supporting reintegration of former offenders through job training and mentorship.
- Ongoing Monitoring and Support: Follow-up services to ensure long-term recovery and prevent re-victimization.

Examples:

- Counseling services for survivors of domestic violence.
- Rehabilitation programs for youth involved in gang violence.
- Trauma recovery programs for war survivors.

Public Health Model of Violence Prevention

Framework

Public health approaches violence prevention using the Social-Ecological Model, which addresses:

- Individual Level: Education on conflict resolution and emotional regulation.
- Relationship Level: Strengthening family bonds and peer support.
- Community Level: Creating safe environments and reducing risk factors like poverty.
- Societal Level: Policy changes, law enforcement, and cultural shifts.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THE PRIMARY, SECONDARY AND TERTIARY PREVENTION

Aspect	Primary	Secondary	Tertiary
Prevention	Prevention	Prevention	Prevention
Goal	Prevent violence before it occurs.	Respond early to reduce harm and prevent recurrence.	Long term care to prevent further harm.
Focus	Population on-wide	At-risk individuals	Victims and risk reduction.
Intervention	Before violence occurs.	Immediately after violence occurs.	Long-term care and follow-up.
Examples	Anti-violence campaigns, hotlines, risk screening.	Domestic violence counseling, trauma recovery,	

CONCLUSION

- Public health approaches to violence prevention require a multi-tiered strategy addressing the root causes, early interventions, and long-term support for affected individuals and communities. Implementing primary, secondary, and tertiary prevention simultaneously ensures a comprehensive reduction in violence and its lasting impacts.

Paper 7 of 7 — PUBLIC HEALTH NURSING (NSG 501)

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY,
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TOPIC: GENDER BASED VIOLENCE

COURSE: PUBLIC HEALTH NURSING (NSG 501)

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GENDER BASED VIOLENCE

Gender-based violence (GBV) encompasses harmful acts directed at individuals based on their gender. It is a global issue rooted in systemic inequality, power imbalances, and cultural norms that perpetuate discrimination and violence against individuals, particularly women and girls. However, men, boys, and gender-diverse individuals are also victims of GBV, though often overlooked. GBV manifests in various forms and occurs across all socioeconomic, cultural, and geographic settings.

Forms of Gender-Based Violence

1. Physical Violence:

- Women: Physical abuse, such as hitting, beating, or assault by intimate partners, family members, or strangers.

- Men: Assaults, including domestic violence, gang violence, or targeted attacks due to perceived weakness or failure to conform to traditional masculinity.

2. Sexual Violence:

- Includes rape, sexual assault, sexual harassment, and forced sexual acts.

Women are disproportionately affected, often facing rape and sexual exploitation during conflicts.

- Men, particularly in conflict zones or prison settings, also experience sexual violence, often underreported due to stigma.

3. Emotional and Psychological Abuse:

Intimidation, threats, humiliation, or controlling behavior.

Both men and women can experience psychological abuse, though women are more often targeted in domestic settings.

4. Economic Violence:

- Women: Denial of financial resources, unequal pay, or restrictions on employment opportunities.

- Men: Financial manipulation in relationships, especially when economic dependence or vulnerability is exploited.

5. Harmful Traditional Practices

Female genital mutilation (FGM), forced marriages, honor killings, and dowry-related violence are directed primarily at women and girls.

Practices like male circumcision or forced participation in violent rituals may affect men.

Causes and Risk Factors of GBV:

1. Cultural and Social Norms

Patriarchal systems that reinforce male dominance and female subservience.

Stereotypes that discourage emotional expression in men and condone aggression.

2. Economic Inequality

Poverty increases vulnerability to GBV by limiting access to resources and support.

3. Conflict and Crisis Settings

Wars, natural disasters, and refugee crises exacerbate GBV, with women facing sexual violence and men forced into combat roles

4. Substance Abuse

Alcohol and drugs can escalate violent tendencies, particularly in domestic settings.

5. Weak Legal Protections

Inadequate laws, poor enforcement, and victim-blaming attitudes hinder prevention and justice.

IMPACT OF GENDER BASED VIOLENCE

1. On Women

- Physical injuries, chronic health issues, unwanted pregnancies, and sexually transmitted infections (STIs).
- Long-term psychological effects such as PTSD, depression, and anxiety.
- Economic dependency and limited opportunities due to stigma or disability.

2. On Men

- Physical harm and mental health issues, including shame and societal rejection.
- Challenges in seeking help due to gender stereotypes.
- Potential perpetuation of violence due to unresolved trauma.

3. On Communities and Societies

- Economic losses from healthcare costs and lost productivity.
- Intergenerational cycles of violence as children exposed to GBV are more likely to become victims or perpetrators.

Prevention and Response

- Prevention

1. Education and Awareness

Promote gender equality and challenge harmful stereotypes through community programs and schools.

Train men and boys to be allies in preventing GBV.

2. Strengthening Legal Frameworks

Implement laws protecting all genders from violence and ensuring accountability for perpetrators.

Criminalize harmful practices like Female Genital Mutilation and marital rape.

3. Community Engagement

Involve religious and cultural leaders in addressing norms that perpetuate GBV.

Foster community-based support systems for victims.

4. Economic Empowerment

Provide women with access to education, job training, and financial resources to reduce vulnerability.

Response

1. Healthcare Support

Establish trauma-informed services for survivors, including medical care and counseling. Train healthcare providers to recognize and address GBV sensitively.

2. Legal Assistance

Ensure survivors have access to legal support to seek justice and protection.

3. Shelters and Crisis Centers

Provide safe spaces for survivors, offering temporary housing and rehabilitation services.

4. Helplines and Technology

Develop confidential reporting systems and helplines for immediate assistance.

Addressing Violence Against Men

While women experience GBV at higher rates, men face unique challenges in acknowledging and addressing their victimization. Efforts to combat GBV must recognize and address violence against men to ensure comprehensive solutions.

1. Combat Stigma

Encourage men to seek help by creating safe and supportive spaces.

Challenge societal norms that equate victimhood with weakness.

2. Tailored Support Services

Develop shelters, counseling, and legal assistance specifically for male survivors.

3. Awareness Campaigns

Highlight that GBV against men is a significant issue and educate communities on its prevalence.

Examples of GBV against women across different regions

Physical Violence

1. Domestic Violence: In the United States, 1 in 4 women experience severe physical violence by an intimate partner.

2. Acid Attacks: In India, acid attacks on women have increased by 300% since 2013, with many cases linked to dowry disputes or rejection of marriage proposals.

3. Female Genital Mutilation (FGM): In Somalia, 98% of women and girls have undergone FGM, a practice that involves the partial or total removal of external female genitalia.

Sexual Violence

1. Rape: In South Africa, a woman is raped every 26 seconds, with many cases going unreported due to fear of stigma and retaliation.

2. Sex Trafficking: In Thailand, thousands of women and girls are trafficked into the sex trade each year, often under the guise of legitimate employment.

3. Marital Rape: In India, marital rape is not explicitly criminalized, leaving many women vulnerable to sexual violence within their own homes.

Psychological and Emotional Abuse

1. Online Harassment: In the European Union, 1 in 10 women have experienced online harassment, including threats, insults, and unwanted messages.

2. Stalking: In Australia, 1 in 5 women have experienced stalking, with many cases involving ex-partners or acquaintances.

3. Forced Marriage: In the United Kingdom, thousands of women and girls are forced into marriage each year, often under the threat of violence or ostracism.

Economic and Social Exclusion

1. Dowry-Related Violence: In Nepal, dowry-related violence is a significant problem, with many women and girls facing physical and emotional abuse for failing to meet dowry demands.

2. Widow Abuse: In Ghana, widows are often subjected to economic and social exclusion, including the loss of property and inheritance rights.

3. Female Infanticide: In China, female infanticide remains a significant issue, driven by a cultural preference for sons and limited access to family planning resources.

Institutional and Systemic Violence

1. Police Brutality: In Brazil, women have reported instances of police brutality, including physical and sexual violence, during protests and demonstrations.

2. Judicial System Failures: In Russia, women often face significant barriers when seeking justice for GBV, including inadequate investigations and lenient sentencing for perpetrators.

3. Healthcare System Failures: In Nigeria, women and girls often face significant challenges when seeking healthcare services, including limited access to maternal healthcare and inadequate treatment for GBV survivors.

CONCLUSION

Gender-based violence is a pervasive issue requiring a multidimensional approach. Solutions must address systemic inequalities, challenge harmful norms, and provide equitable support for all genders. By fostering awareness, legal reform, and community action, societies can work towards eliminating GBV and ensuring safety and dignity for everyone.